

Osmosis

Osmosis is the movement of water across a selectively permeable membrane from a region of low solute concentration to a region of high solute concentration. Water moves toward the side with more solute because the solute lowers the water potential there. In a hypotonic solution a cell gains water and may burst.

Enzymes

Enzymes are biological catalysts, almost always proteins, that speed up reactions by lowering the activation energy. Each enzyme has an active site whose shape fits a specific substrate, which is why enzymes are specific. Above the optimum temperature the enzyme denatures and stops working.